Resume Writing Guide

CEHD
College of Education + Human Development

Essential Resume Components

Your resume is a document that communicates your relevant experiences, skills and strengths to an employer. It's an effective and efficient way to tell your story and highlight your unique qualifications. While each resume is distinct and should reflect your personal brand, there are essential components that create the foundation of a strong resume. These components are your **Name Block**, **Education**, and **Experience**.

NAME BLOCK

Your name block is an effective way to communicate your personal brand to employers, make you stand out and add visual appeal to your resume. Use the same name block on all of your marketing materials (cover letter, resume, reference page) for consistency and to create brand recognition. Be creative with your name block and use elements (fonts and design) that reflect your brand, but that are also fitting for your career field.

- Your name should be the largest text on your resume. Usually 16 – 18 point font.
- List a phone number where you can easily be reached and have a brief, professional voicemail message as it may be an employer's first impression of you.
- Use your U of M email address if you are a current student or recent graduate.
- Include your LinkedIn profile or online portfolio url.

JOB SEEKER

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SUMMARY STATEMENTS

A summary statement draws in the reader's attention and highlights the specific skills and experiences you have that an employer is looking for. A summary statement is optional, but can be a great way to tailor your resume, incorporate your personal brand, and make it easier for an employer to see your relevant qualifications and skills. Summary statements can have various titles including ***Summary of Skills, Professional Highlights or Career Profile.***

- Be specific, descriptive and focus on the qualifications of the position or type of position you are applying to.
- Review position postings to determine the specific skills and qualifications to focus on in your summary.

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+ Incorporate your career interests and goals and use industry specific language.
+ If you have multiple positions that used similar skills a summary statement can reduce the need for repetition of skills in each position.

Summary of Skills

- Learn new ideas and concepts quickly and enjoy teaching and motivating others
- Communicate effectively with people from diverse backgrounds by listening to their needs
- Skilled in taking charge of a group and leading them to success
- Strong customer service skills and a warm, friendly, calm, and entertaining personality
- Known as a reliable and trustworthy employee who consistently meets deadlines
- Creative and good at problem solving under pressure
- Focused, determined and self-motivated with a sense of humor

Professional Highlights

- Over two years of experience in all aspects of human resource development
- Capable of working quickly and accurately under pressure to successfully meet deadlines
- Demonstrated ability to meet organizational needs and solve complex problems effectively
- Proficient computer skills, including detailed knowledge of all Microsoft Office applications and ability to learn new software programs quickly

CAREER PROFILE

Self-motivated individual driven by a strong interest in contributing to the success of post-secondary students from diverse backgrounds. Experienced in coordinating undergraduate activities, providing leadership and support to student research assistants. Excels in teaching and communicating ideas. Inspires enthusiasm and confidence in students. Passionate about teaching and confident in ability to lead others in doing the same.

EDUCATION

Focus on your college level education listing your most recent institution and degree first. Include the date you received your degree or your expected graduation date. It is not necessary to include your high school degree.

+ Include Name of Institution, City, State, Degree, Major and Graduation Date
+ List the correct degree (Bachelor of Science or Bachelor of Arts) and spell it out rather using B.S. or B.A.
+ GPA is optional, but consider including your GPA if it's over 3.0.
+ Teachers - list your teaching license(s) under "Education" or as a separate "License" heading
+ Optional education sub-headings: Licenses (if not required for position – separate heading if it is), Certifications, Language Proficiency, Intercollegiate Athletics, Learning Abroad, Relevant Coursework, Honors, Awards

University of Minnesota — Minneapolis, MN
Bachelor of Science — May 2016
Major: Business and Marketing Education, College of Education and Human Development
Minor: Management, Carlson School of Management

Bachelor of Science, *Kinesiology* — Anticipated Graduation: May 2018
University of Minnesota — Minneapolis, MN

Academic & Athletic Honors
+University of Minnesota Scholar-Athlete, 2014, 2015, 2016
+Academic All Big Ten, 2015, 2016
+Nominee for NCAA Leadership Conference
+Robert & Betty VanTassel Endowed Scholarship Recipient, 2014, 2015
+Donna J Olson Award for Service and Leadership

Relevant Coursework
Advanced Exercise Testing, Human Anatomy, Human Physiology, Exercise Physiology, Biomechanics Measurement and Evaluation in Research Kinesiology

University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, MN — May 2015
Bachelor of Science, Magna Cum Laude, GPA 3.63
Major: Kinesiology
Concentration: Pre-Occupational Therapy

University of Minnesota, Twin-Cities — **Minneapolis, MN**
Bachelor of Science — Expected May 2018
Intended Major: Family Social Science

MINNESOTA TEACHING LICENSES: **Early Childhood Education (birth – 3rd grade)**
Early Childhood Special Education (birth – age 6)

EDUCATION
University of Minnesota, College of Education and Human Development — Minneapolis, MN
Masters of Education; Early Childhood Special Education — Expected May 2017
Bachelors of Science; Foundations of Education, Early Childhood — May 2016
Minor in Youth Studies

American Heart Association, CPR — 2015 – present

University of Minnesota, College of Education and Human Development, Minneapolis, MN
Masters of Art; Educational Psychology: Counseling and Student Personnel Psychology — May, 2015
Concentration: Higher Education

Bachelor of Arts; Psychology — May, 2013

EXPERIENCE

Include both paid and unpaid experiences where you gained relevant and transferable skills. You can differentiate between relevant and non-relevant experience by grouping them under separate headings. For example, "Relevant Experience" and "Additional Experience."

+ For each experience include position title, name of organization, city, state and dates.
+ List positions in reverse chronological order (most recent experience first).
+ Multiple positions within a company should be listed separately (still in reverse chronological order) under the company name and can highlight any promotions.
+ Headings are a good way to organize information and tailor your resume.
+ Other headings to consider: Professional Development, Community Service, Computer Skills, Language Skills, Mentoring Experience, Career Development, Licenses, Certifications

Position title Dates
Name of Organization (Company, School, Club, etc.) City, State
• A bulleted list of your position responsibilities and accomplishments
• The most important information, with the most detail, should be listed first
• Write strong skills statements that are concise and to the point, but include relevant details

Skills Statements

Strong Skills Statements = Action Verb + Details (what, where, when, how, why) + Outcome/Result (if possible)

Action Verb	Start skills statements with a strong action verb – avoid repetition and vague words like "Worked," "Taught," and "Responsible for" and stay away from personal pronouns (I, we, me)
Details	The situation, problem, or need that you fulfilled. Quantifying and qualifying your work is important. (ex. Managed 40 internal accounts…, Communicated to management daily…)
Outcome/Result	What happened as a result of your action on the problem, situation, or need? How did the result contribute to the organization or company? How did you gain skills or discover strengths?

Rowing Representative, *Student Athlete Committee, University of Minnesota*, Minneapolis, MN 2014 - 2015
- Collaborated with other University of Minnesota athletes through monthly meetings
- Discussed issues concerning the NCAA, Big Ten Conference, and U of MN Athletics
- Spoke at various elementary schools to students regarding healthy and active lifestyle

Intern, Family Violence Center Spring Semester, 2016
Eastside Neighborhood Services Minneapolis, MN
- Co-facilitated family and parent education courses with Licensed Family Social Worker
- Maintained organized case-files efficiently with limited administrative time
- Observed court ordered family visitations and learned relevant policies and procedures

Panera Bread 5/2013 - Present Minneapolis, MN

Shift Manager 1/2014 - Present

- Promoted for providing excellent customer service, while maintaining a clean, safe work environment, and while supporting all areas of store, including bakery, food line, dining room and cash register
- Organized, directed, and supervised associates while keeping morale and productivity high
- Responded to and resolved customer and associate problems in a professional manner
- Demonstrated "take-charge" attitude and excellent leadership during busy times
- Recognized by peers and supervisors for ambition and eagerness to learn
- Tracked store sales and labor using Excel database and maintained a clean and safe store

Trainer/Associate 5/2014 – 1/2016

- Trained new employees in standard procedure utilizing classroom reading materials, hands-on experiential learning and through leading by example
- Helped new employees gain the skills and confidence needed to perform job duties with optimism and mastery
- Earned "WOW" award in first month of service for displaying unmatched service through kindness, customer service, or general skill as recognized by peers

Adaptive Sports Club, Department of Recreational Sports University of Minnesota

Member September 2015 – June, 2016

- Promoted and facilitated the involvement of University students and staff with disabilities in sport clubs, intramural sports, outdoor recreation, aquatic activities, program offerings
- Organized adaptive recreation, exercise, and sport activities for students and staff

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Format and Visual Appeal

+ Be consistent in your formatting and fonts
+ Keep the most important information on the top portion of the first page
+ Set your margins between .75 and 1 inch
+ Use an easy to read font at 10 – 12 pt
+ Define sections and use clear headings
+ Balance text and white space
+ Use font, size and **bold** or *italics* to highlight important information and headings
+ Keep dates on the right side of the page
+ Stay away from using resume templates, they limit your flexibility and creativity
+ Keep resume length to 1 - 2 pages
+ Use high quality resume paper when printing
+ Spell out acronyms
+ References are a separate document from your resume

FOR MORE INFORMATION

CEHD Career Services
360 Education Sciences Building
www.cehd.umn.edu